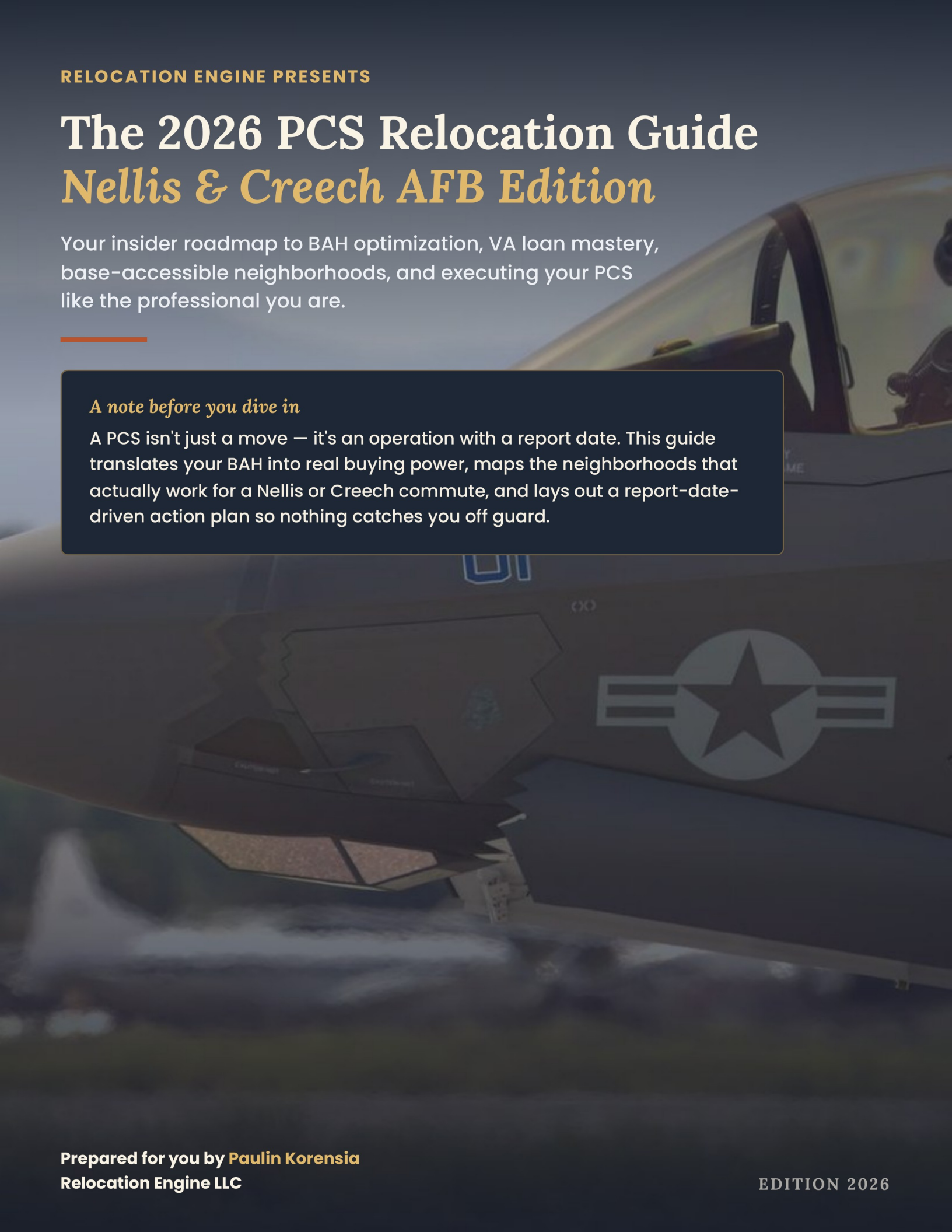
RELOCATION ENGINE PRESENTS

The 2026 PCS Relocation Guide

Nellis & Creech AFB Edition

Your insider roadmap to BAH optimization, VA loan mastery, base-accessible neighborhoods, and executing your PCS like the professional you are.



A note before you dive in

A PCS isn't just a move — it's an operation with a report date. This guide translates your BAH into real buying power, maps the neighborhoods that actually work for a Nellis or Creech commute, and lays out a report-date-driven action plan so nothing catches you off guard.

Prepared for you by Paulin Korensia
Relocation Engine LLC

EDITION 2026

PART ONE · THE MILITARY FINANCIAL ADVANTAGE

BAH Optimization & Nevada's Tax-Free Advantage

Your BAH isn't just rent money — it's buying power, and Nevada's tax structure can make it stretch further than almost anywhere else you'll be stationed.

BAH vs. Mortgage Math

2026 BAH rates for the Nellis AFB/Las Vegas Military Housing Area (MHA: NV212) scale by rank and dependency status.

$1,629+/mo

JUNIOR ENLISTED (E-1–E-4)

Starting point: E-1 without dependents. Rises with each pay grade and with dependents.

$1,737–$2,208+

NCO (E-5–E-6)

E-5 without dependents ($1,737) to E-6 with dependents ($2,208) — roughly 17–20% more with dependents.

Up to $2,814/mo

SENIOR NCO & OFFICERS (E-7+/O-1+)

Scaling up to the O-7+ ceiling for the MHA, with dependents.

> ***2026 DFAS BAH rates for the Nellis AFB/Las Vegas Military Housing Area (NV212), effective January 1, 2026. Exact figures vary by pay grade and dependency status — confirm yours with the official DoD BAH calculator before budgeting.***

In the Las Vegas market, BAH typically covers the bulk of a mortgage payment on a VA loan — meaning the same dollar that disappears into a landlord's pocket every month can instead build equity in a home you own.

RENT VS. BUY, IN ONE SENTENCE

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Nevada's Tax-Free Advantage — What It Actually Takes

Nevada is one of nine states with no state income tax. But here's the nuance that matters: under the Servicemembers Civil Relief Act, active-duty military pay is taxed by your **State of Legal Residence (SLR)** — not by where you're physically stationed. Simply reporting to Nellis or Creech doesn't automatically make your pay NV-tax-free unless Nevada is (or becomes) your SLR.

How to actually capture this: if your current SLR is a taxed state, a PCS to Nevada is a natural moment to consider updating it via **DD Form 2058** — talk to your base legal assistance office first. Under the Veterans Auto and Education Improvement Act, your spouse can generally elect the same state of legal residence too.

WORTH A CONVERSATION WITH BASE LEGAL BEFORE YOU FILE ANYTHING

VA Loan Snapshot

0% Down

NO DOWN PAYMENT REQUIRED

Not 5%, not 20% — $0. Cash is still needed for earnest money and inspection.

No PMI, Ever

AT ANY DOWN PAYMENT LEVEL

Saves roughly $100–$250/month versus a conventional loan under 20% down.

No Loan Limit*

WITH FULL ENTITLEMENT

*The $832,750 conforming baseline (2026) applies only to buyers with partial entitlement.

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The COE, the Funding Fee & MPRs

Get Your COE First

- VA.gov / eBenefits portal — instant to 2 days
- Your lender requests it for you — 1–3 days
- VA Form 26-1880 by mail — 2–6 weeks

Get your Certificate of Eligibility before you start touring homes.

The Funding Fee

- **2.15%** first-time use, $0 down
- **3.3%** subsequent use, $0 down
- **0.5%** IRRRLs & loan assumptions

Waived for VA disability, Purple Heart, and eligible surviving spouses.

VA Minimum Property Requirements (MPRs)

A VA appraisal checks for safety and soundness, not just value — working utilities, a sound roof, no exposed wiring, and no major health or safety hazards. Newer construction in the Northwest Valley and North Las Vegas typically clears MPRs without issue; older resale stock elsewhere in the valley can need repairs negotiated with the seller before closing.

Since 2020, full-entitlement VA buyers face no VA-imposed loan ceiling — a real advantage over California's high-cost-area conforming limits, where a 20% down payment on the same price point can mean six figures in cash just to get to the closing table.

BUYING POWER, COMPARED TO CALIFORNIA

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PART TWO · WHERE TO LAND

Base-Accessible & Military-Friendly Neighborhoods

Nellis and Creech have very different commute realities — know which base you're reporting to before you pick a zip code.

Nellis AFB

THE NELLIS COMMUTE MAP

~8–12 miles NE of the Strip. Most valley neighborhoods reach it in 15–30 minutes; North Las Vegas is fastest.

Creech AFB

THE CREECH COMMUTE MAP

~35–45 miles NW near Indian Springs via US-95. No on-base family housing — every Creech family commutes.



Northwest Valley (Centennial Hills / Skye Canyon)

PREFERRED · CREECH COMMUTERS

The default choice for Creech AFB personnel thanks to direct US-95 access, and increasingly popular with Nellis families who want newer, master-planned construction. The trade-off is a longer Nellis commute than North Las Vegas.



North Las Vegas (Aliante / Valley Vista)

HIGHEST MILITARY CONCENTRATION

The fastest Nellis gate access in the valley and some of the best square-footage-per-BAH-dollar available, at a lower price point than Summerlin or Henderson.

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Henderson & Summerlin, and the Cheat Sheet



Henderson & Summerlin (Senior Ranks / Officers)

LONG-TERM EQUITY

The trade-off here is commute time for school quality, resale value, and amenities — a common calculus for senior NCOs and officers planning their next PCS or retirement.

NEIGHBORHOOD	NELLIS	CREECH	BEST FOR
NW Valley	~20–25 min	~35–45 min	Creech families, new construction
North LV	~10–15 min	~50–55 min	Max BAH value, fastest Nellis access
Henderson/Summerlin	~25–35 min	~55–65 min	Senior ranks, long-term equity

> ***Off-peak estimates. For Creech shift workers commuting from Henderson/Summerlin, morning rush hour through the I-15 N to US-95 N interchange regularly pushes that drive to 60–75 minutes.***

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PART THREE · LIFE ON & OFF BASE

Military Family Life & Local Amenities

Quality of life outside the gate is what makes a PCS to Vegas actually enjoyable.

On-Base vs. Off-Base Amenities

~10–35 min

TO THE NELLIS COMMISSARY & BX

North LV closest (~10–15 min); NW Valley (~20–25 min); Henderson/Summerlin farthest.

Mike O'Callaghan MMC

MILITARY MEDICAL CENTER, NELLIS AFB

Drive times mirror the Commissary/BX range — a real factor for frequent appointments.

Outdoor Rec for Off-Duty Days



Red Rock Canyon

A 13-mile scenic loop with world-class hiking and climbing, about 20 minutes from the NW Valley.



Mt. Charleston

Pine forests, cool summer air, and snow in winter — a 45-minute drive up US-95/SR-157.



Lake Mead

Boating, kayaking, and beaches minutes from Henderson.

Youth Sports & School Districts

Clark County School District (CCSD) is one of the largest districts in the country, and many schools serving North Las Vegas and the Northwest Valley participate in federal Impact Aid for military-connected students. Magnet and charter programs add flexibility for families arriving mid-year.

PART FOUR · EAT & LIVE LIKE A LOCAL

Restaurants Offering Military Discounts

Beyond the neighborhood spots, several national chains near Nellis extend real discounts to military ID holders.



25% OFF

Guy Fieri's Vegas Kitchen & Bar

Big, bold Flavortown comfort food, think Trash Can Nachos and a Bacon Mac 'n Cheese Burger, served on a 6,500 sq ft patio overlooking the Strip.



15% OFF

Hard Rock Cafe

Three floors of music memorabilia and Strip views, anchored by the world's largest Rock Shop and a 1,200-capacity concert stage.



10% OFF

Outback Steakhouse

Australian-inspired steakhouse comfort, with big, juicy cuts cooked your way, at all seven Las Vegas locations.



10% OFF

Cracker Barrel Old Country Store

Traditional Southern comfort food and all-day breakfast classics, a reliable, family-friendly stop valley-wide.

> ***Discount programs and percentages can change without notice — confirm current terms and bring a valid military ID when you visit.***

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Off-Strip, Off-Duty Entertainment



Golden Knights

NHL · T-MOBILE ARENA

The valley's breakout sports obsession — Vegas' first major pro franchise.

Raiders

NFL · ALLEGIANT STADIUM

A short drive from the Strip corridor, easy from most valley neighborhoods.



Las Vegas Ballpark

AAA baseball with the Las Vegas Aviators, Downtown Summerlin — an easy, affordable family night out.

Local Parks, Valley-Wide: splash pads, playgrounds, and rec centers in nearly every master-planned community.

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Cirque du Soleil Military Discounts

Some of the best entertainment deals on the Strip are reserved for military families.



35–50% OFF

Mystère (Treasure Island)

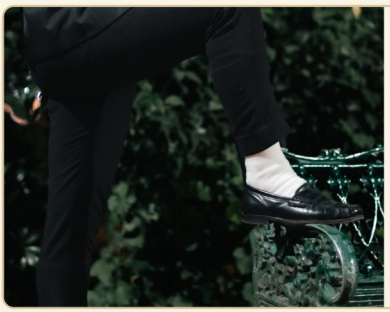
Three decades of fearless acrobatics, from Chinese poles to hand-to-hand balancing and trapeze, in the show that's become a rite of passage on the Strip.



25% OFF

KÀ (MGM Grand)

One of Cirque's most ambitious productions, telling an epic twins' journey through martial arts, blazing pyrotechnics, and jaw-dropping aerial work.



25% OFF

Michael Jackson ONE (Mandalay Bay)

63 dancers and aerialists set to Michael's biggest hits in surround sound, an urban, hip-hop-driven tribute built for full-volume energy.



UP TO 20% OFF

"O" (Bellagio)

World-class swimmers, divers, and acrobats perform in, on, and above water inside a theater built to feel like a European opera house.

> ***Cirque discount tiers depend on show, date, and seating availability — confirm current terms with a valid military ID when booking.***

Other Top Shows With Military Rates



25% OFF

Blue Man Group (Luxor)

Three silent, blue-skinned performers turn custom instruments and paint-splashed drumming into a loud, colorful show that crosses every language barrier.



$10 OFF

Tournament of Kings (Excalibur)

Real horses, jousting, and sword fights as King Arthur's court faces off against the wizard Mordred, with a feast included, eaten hands-only.



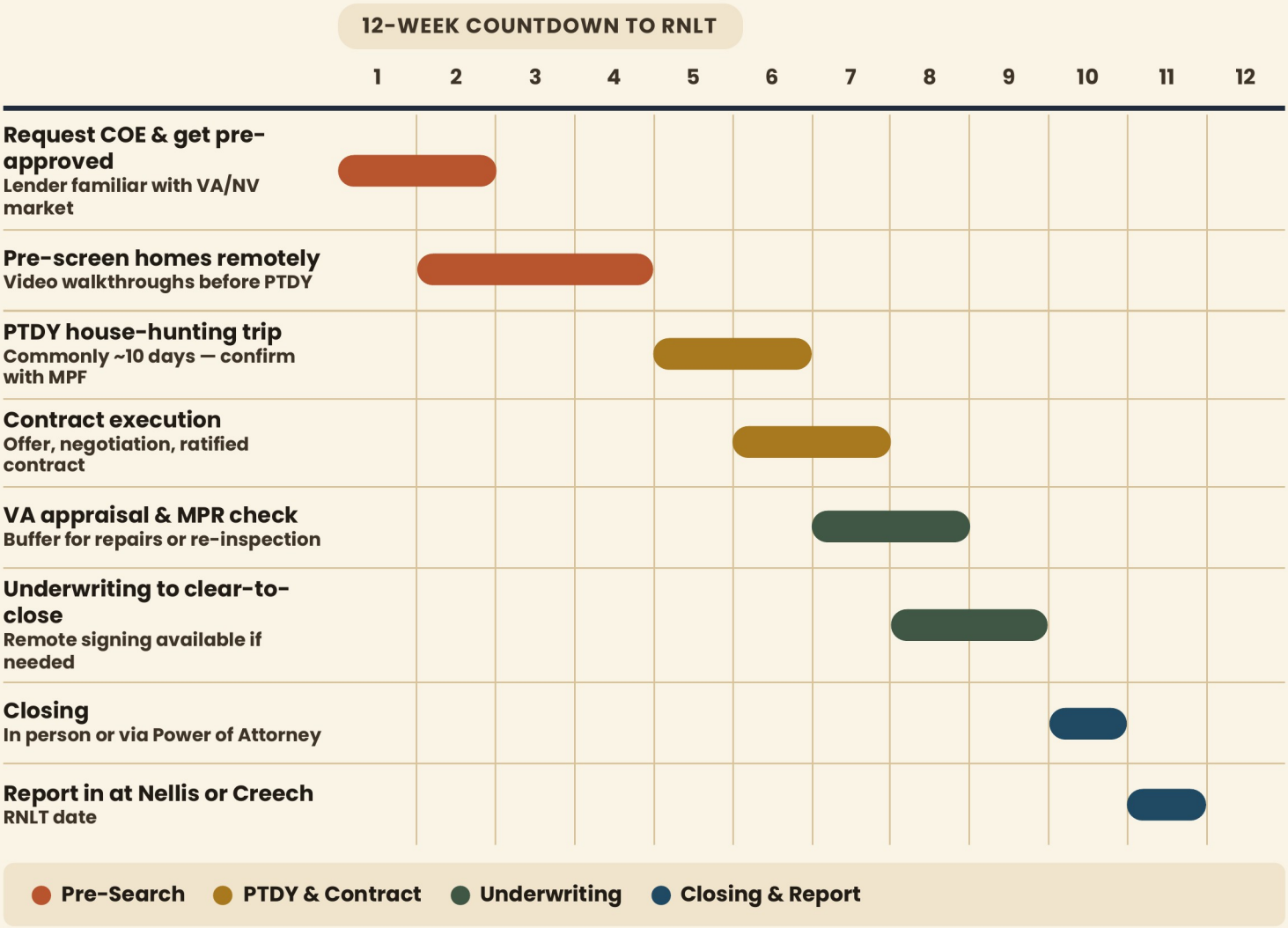
WOW – The Vegas Spectacular (Rio)

30+ performers, 3D projections, and water effects in a family-friendly acrobatic spectacle. Active-duty and veterans often find tickets subsidized through Vet Tix.

PART FIVE · THE PCS ACTION PLAN

Your RNLT Back-Planning Timeline

Work backward from your Report-No-Later-Than date.



If orders drop with less runway than this, the plan compresses — not disappears. Pre-screening and remote closing tools exist specifically for a short-notice PCS, covered on the next page.

FEWER THAN 12 WEEKS? KEEP READING.

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PTDY, Remote Closings & Bridging Housing

The tools that make a tight PCS timeline actually work.

PTDY House Hunting

Permissive TDY authorizes non-chargeable leave for house hunting — self-funded, command-approved, typically taken 30–60 days before your report date. Commonly cited as up to **10 days** for a CONUS-to-CONUS PCS — confirm your precise entitlement with your MPF.

- Pre-screen with video walkthroughs before you fly out
- Stack showings back-to-back
- Arrive with COE and pre-approval already in hand

Remote Buying Capabilities

If orders drop late, or PTDY isn't enough time to close, the deal doesn't have to wait for you to be physically present.

- Video walkthroughs and virtual tours
- Remote online notarization where available
- Military or Special Power of Attorney for closing

Bridging Temporary Housing: TLE

Up to 21 Days

CONUS TEMPORARY LODGING EXPENSE

Increased from 14 days effective Nov. 2024 — split between your old and new duty station.

$290/day Cap

COMBINED LODGING & MEALS

Reimbursement, not upfront payment — keep every receipt, then file your voucher.

Stack it smart: use PTDY to lock in the home, TLE to bridge the gap once you arrive, and a Power of Attorney to keep the closing on schedule if your report date and closing date land in the same week.

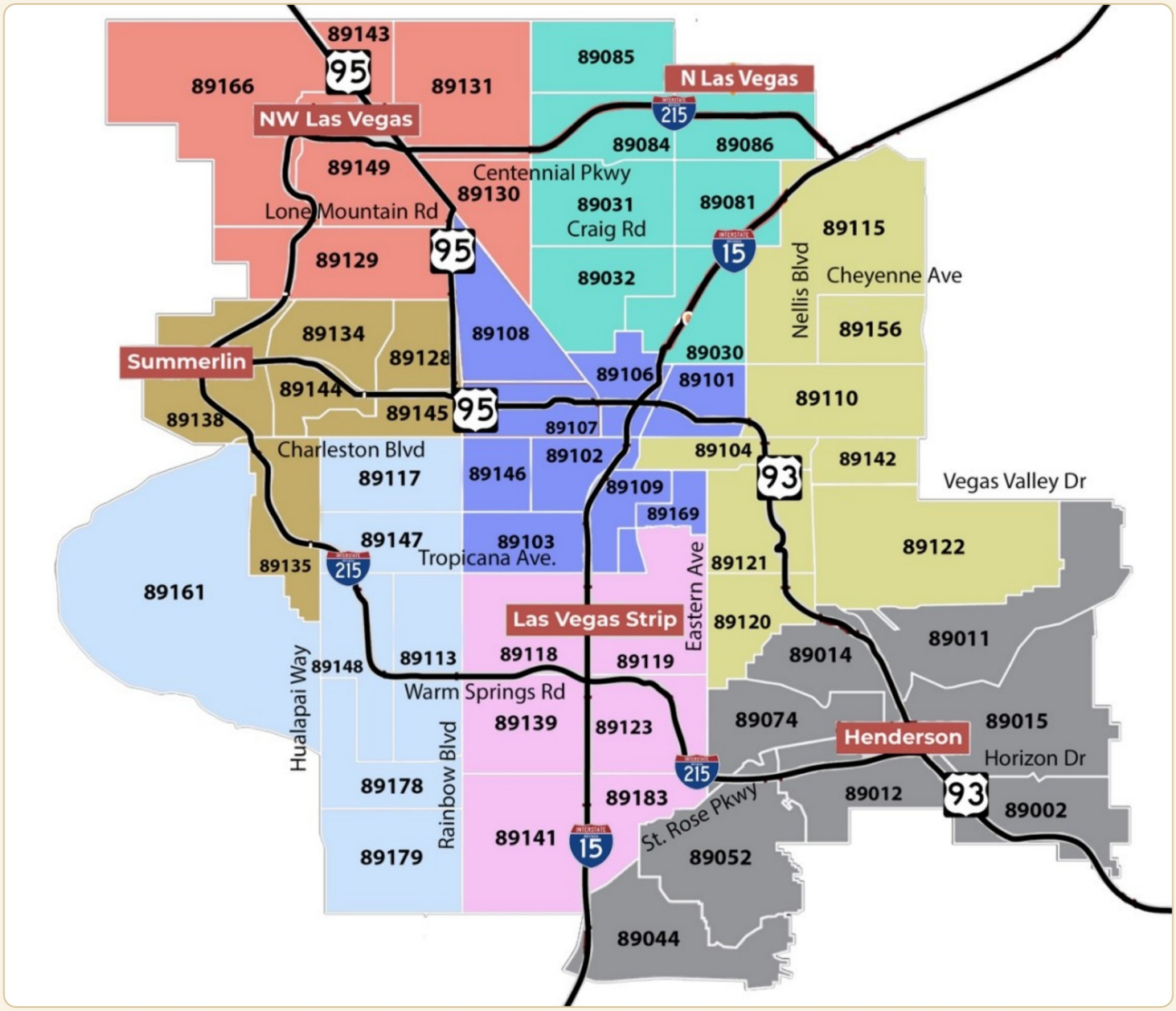
THE THREE TOOLS WORK BEST TOGETHER, NOT ALONE

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LOCAL REFERENCE

Know Your Zip Codes

A quick visual reference for the zip codes and communities mentioned throughout this guide.



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LOCAL REFERENCE

Phone Numbers

Clark County and Las Vegas — worth saving for move-in week.

LV Metropolitan Police Dept.	702-828-3111
Henderson Police Dept.	702-267-5000
NV Highway Patrol	702-486-4100
Animal Control — Las Vegas	702-229-6444
Animal Control — Clark County	702-455-7710
Animal Control — Henderson	702-267-4970
SPCA No Kill Animal Sanctuary	702-873-7722
HCWS No Kill Animal Sanctuary	702-655-4800
Assessor's Office	702-455-4323
Better Business Bureau	702-320-4500
Chamber of Commerce	702-641-5822
City Clerk (Las Vegas)	702-229-6311
City Hall (Las Vegas)	702-229-6011
Clark County Bar Association	702-387-6011
Clark County Government Center	702-455-6552
Clark County Library District	702-734-7323
UNLV	702-895-3011
College of Southern Nevada	702-651-5000
Cox Cable	702-384-8084
DMV	702-486-4368
Gaming Work Permit	702-486-2000
Health Cards	702-759-0960
Homestead Info	702-222-0251
Hunting & Fishing Licenses	855-542-6369
Immunizations	702-759-0850
Legal Aid Center of S. NV	702-386-1070
Marriage Licenses	702-671-0600
McCarran Airport Info	702-261-5211
NV Dept. of Veterans Services	702-636-3070
NV Energy	702-402-5555
Review Journal	702-383-0400
Las Vegas Sun	702-385-3111
Parks & Recreation, Clark County	702-455-8200
Polling Locations	702-455-8683
Regional Flood Control District	702-685-0000
Regional Transportation Comm. (RTC)	702-676-1500
School District	702-799-5000
Social Security Administration	800-772-1213
Suicide Prevention	702-486-8225
Treasurer's Office	702-486-6980
USPS Postal Answer Line	800-275-8777
USPS Main Branch (Las Vegas)	800-275-8777
Voter Registration	702-455-8683

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